

PDFPW Demo

Browser-based PDF Presenter Console

Adapted from pdfpc demo

2026-01-15

Introduction



Hi! Welcome to the demo of PDFPW, a browser-based PDF presentation tool.

Setting up

- Open the presentation window by scanning the QR code or clicking the link
- The presentation window and presenter console will synchronize automatically
- Use the browser's presenter view if needed

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Let's get started!

The presenter view

The presenter console is the one on your monitor, visible only to the presenter.

- Current and next slides
- Presentation timer
- Current slide number and total slides
- Overlay information
- Additional status information

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Of course, the presentation window only shows the current slide.

Navigation



Forward navigation:

- Arrow keys: →, ↓
- Page: Page Down
- Enter/Return, Space
- Left mouse button

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Basic movement

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Fast navigation:

- Press Shift + ←/→ to jump in larger steps

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- PDFPW supports such overlays
- Note the overlay indicator showing current step
- The slide counter shows the correct slide number
- Too long overlays may be boring for the audience
- Use them wisely!

Movement

- Normal movement inside an overlay jumps through each step
- Some actions allow jumping between slides directly
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Definition of overlays

- PDFPW reads overlay information from PDF page labels
- Custom overlay definitions may be supported via configuration

Jumping to specific slides

- Press G to enter a slide number to jump to (planned feature)
- Slide viewing history can be navigated (planned feature)
- Thumbnail overview for easy navigation (planned feature)
- Hyperlinks work within the PDF
- Home and End keys work as expected

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This makes navigation flexible and efficient.

Features



Notes can be shown in the presenter console.

- Notes are defined via external configuration files
- Notes are automatically loaded when available
- Notes apply to slides in an overlay group

Controlling the presentation view

- **Freeze** the presentation view

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- **Freeze** the presentation view
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- **Fade to black** the presentation view
 - Useful when switching between slides and blackboard
- **Hide** the presentation view
 - Useful for showing other applications
- Toggle these modes via the presenter console controls
- Status icons reflect the current state

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Controlling the timer

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Controlling the timer

- Timer starts automatically when you begin the presentation
- Pause the timer as needed
- Toggle between timer modes (count up / count down / current time)
- Reset the timer when needed

- **Pointer mode** for highlighting specific areas

Pointer and spotlight

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 - Toggle via presenter console
 - Adjustable size
- **Spotlight mode** shades the background

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 - Toggle via presenter console
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- **Spotlight mode** shades the background
 - Similar to pointer mode but with different visual effect
- Return to normal mode anytime

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- **Note:** Drawings are temporary and not saved

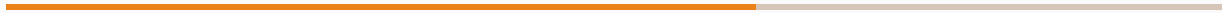
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- Adjust the presenter console layout
- The interface is responsive to different screen sizes
- Browser-based flexibility for multiple setups

Interface



Don't worry about memorizing all the features!

- All controls are visible in the presenter console
- Intuitive interface with clear labels
- No need to memorize keyboard shortcuts
- Everything is accessible via mouse/touch

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Simple and user-friendly!

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- Duration settings

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- Presenter notes
- Slide customization

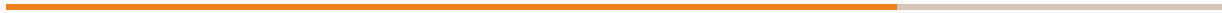
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- Duration settings
- Presenter notes
- Slide customization
- Configuration via .pdfpc files (compatible with pdfpc format)
- Easy to edit text-based format (JSON)

Technical



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- Uses Broadcast Channel API for window synchronization
- Supports modern browsers with File System Access API
- PDF.js for reliable PDF rendering
- Progressive enhancement with graceful fallbacks

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- Compatible with `.pdfpc` configuration files
- Supports the same overlay notation as `pdfpc`
- Works with PDFs generated from LaTeX, Typst, and other tools
- Leverages existing PDF presentation ecosystem

PDFPW respects PDF page transitions:

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- Smooth visual experience for your audience

Conclusion

- Support slides after your “last” slide

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 - Advanced topics, bibliography, Q&A, etc.
- The slide count helps you track progress
- Easy navigation to any slide

—

THE END

**There may be additional slides with extra information,
available on demand if the audience asks**

Appendix

Acknowledgements

- This demo is adapted from the pdfpc demo
- pdfpc was a fork of pdf-presenter-console
- Many thanks to the original authors and contributors

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Thank you for trying PDFPW!

For more information, visit the project repository.